

is only going to lead to hackers picking up your details, and you'll have only yourself to blame. This process of tricking you into sharing your information is known as phishing. And software that engage in this kind of behaviour are known as scare-ware. If such software go a step further and demand money for making your system function properly again, they are known as ransomware.

In a very common practice, many users receive mails from seemingly trusted sources, stating that the said user has provided incorrect information for important documents, and that they will have to resend their information to revive a suspended account or some similar scare tactic. People will end up going to the imposter version the hacker wanted to redirect them to, and end up providing bank account and email account details willingly. In the case you're looking to visit any such website, always visit the encrypted and original website by using a popular search engine to obtain the website details. Big providers like Google, Yahoo! and Bing always give correct and accurate results, and can be trusted to provide the original links for certified websites.



Beware of such pop-ups

In other methods, flashy banner ads on websites are created as sources of malware. Clicking on them automatically gives them permission to install the said malware onto your device. In most cases, the malware simply logs keystrokes and sends them to the hacker, allowing them to monitor your data and thus making it extremely easy to get access to your private information. While your anti-virus should help prevent the download and execution of such malicious software, it's better to be safe than sorry and just not click on these banners.

### Is your password "123456"?

When it comes to how you store your confidential data, you need to take a hard, long look at your passwords for your various accounts. The dilemma